

PENICELLA BEN ZUNGUZE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Accomplished Group Database Manager with 18+ years of experience designing, optimizing, and securing large-scale financial database systems. Expert in Oracle, SQL Server, DB2, and cloud migrations (Azure, OCI, AWS). Proven record in driving system performance, ensuring 99.98% uptime, and leading database teams in highly regulated banking environments. Adept at hybrid and distributed work models with strong expertise in disaster recovery, automation, and regulatory compliance.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Database Management:** Oracle 19c, SQL Server 2022, DB2 PureScale, PostgreSQL, MySQL
 - **Cloud Platforms:** Oracle Cloud Infrastructure, Microsoft Azure, AWS RDS, Private Cloud
 - **Performance & Optimization:** Query Tuning, HA Clustering, Disaster Recovery, Automation
 - **Banking Systems:** SWIFT Alliance, RTGS, Smart Vista, OFSAA, Core Banking Migration
 - **Leadership & Strategy:** Team Leadership, IT Governance, Budget Management, Mentoring
 - **Compliance & Security:** Data Encryption, Regulatory Reporting, Audit Preparedness, Zero-Breach Environments
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ZB Financial Holdings — Harare, Zimbabwe

Group Database Manager / Team Leader Database | Aug 2022 – Sept 2025

- Managed and optimized database infrastructure for 10+ mission-critical banking applications, maintaining 99.98% uptime and meeting strict SLA requirements.
- Designed and implemented Oracle 19c architecture, improving query performance by 35% and reducing system latency.
- Automated disaster recovery processes, cutting restoration time by 70% and enhancing business continuity readiness.
- Led cloud migration initiatives across Oracle Cloud, Azure, and Private Cloud environments, improving scalability and reducing on-premises costs by 25%.
- Oversaw integration of high-availability systems including Fusion Essence (DB2 PureScale), OFSAA, RTGS, Smart Vista, and SWIFT Alliance 7.0.
- Directed team-wide optimization and security audits, ensuring zero data breaches and full compliance with financial regulations (RBZ, PCI DSS).

ZB Financial Holdings — Harare, Zimbabwe

Database Analyst | Nov 2014 – July 2022

- Managed hybrid database environments (Oracle, DB2, SQL Server) serving 3,000+ internal users with 99.95% availability.
- Developed and implemented robust backup, recovery, and encryption frameworks, reducing data vulnerability by 40%.
- Provided architectural support for critical systems including AFROPACK, SAGE VIP Payroll, EQ3, and Internet Banking platforms.
- Performed diagnostic tuning and query optimization, improving report generation speeds by 50% and meeting all regulatory SLAs.
- Conducted capacity planning and performance forecasting to support business growth initiatives.

ZB Financial Holdings — Harare, Zimbabwe

Systems Analyst | Jul 2008 – Nov 2014

- Conducted systems analysis and feasibility studies for enterprise system upgrades, documenting architecture for 15+ core banking applications.
- Designed and implemented integration for CARD systems (Sparrow, PRIME Online) and Cashier (Branch Automation), reducing transaction processing time by 30%.
- Collaborated with development teams to deploy scalable applications ensuring continuous uptime and seamless user experience.
- Created technical documentation and training materials for system transitions and new implementations.

ZB Financial Holdings — Harare, Zimbabwe

Systems Integrator / Programmer / Senior Programmer | Jul 2003 – Jun 2008

- Designed and optimized core financial software applications, improving internal process speed by 25% through code optimization and system tuning.
- Managed system integrations ensuring seamless data flow between back-end and front-end services across multiple platforms.
- Developed and enforced security and access control procedures, reducing unauthorized access attempts by 90%.
- Provided technical leadership and mentorship to junior programmers, improving team productivity by 20%.

KEY PROJECTS & IMPACT

SWIFT Alliance 7.0 Rollout

- Directed implementation across all branches, improving message security and compliance while reducing processing errors by 45%.

Core Banking Migration (Fusion Essence)

- Executed transition to DB2 PureScale ensuring seamless data continuity and improving transaction throughput by 60%.

Payroll Transformation

- Implemented SAGE VIP Payroll for 1,000+ employees with zero downtime, automating 85% of manual processes.

Oracle Private Cloud & OFSAA Deployment

- Strengthened risk monitoring and analytics capabilities, reducing reporting time from days to real-time analysis.

RTGS & Smart Vista System Support

- Maintained real-time high-transaction platforms processing \$2B+ monthly transfers with 100% accuracy and security.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Science (Hons) Computer Science

National University of Science & Technology (NUST) | 2002

Certifications & Training

- Oracle Database Administrator (11g & 19c) Training — Adept Solutions
- SWIFT Alliance 7.0 Operations & Management Training
- Project Management Training — ZB Financial Holdings

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Databases:** Oracle 19c, SQL Server 2022, PostgreSQL, DB2, MySQL, DB2 PureScale
- **Operating Systems:** Windows Server, Oracle Linux, IBM AIX, AS/400
- **Cloud & Virtualization:** Oracle Cloud Infrastructure, Microsoft Azure, AWS RDS, Private Cloud
- **Tools & Reporting:** Power BI, Crystal Reports, Dreamweaver, Visio
- **Scripting & Automation:** SQL, PL/SQL, Python, PowerShell, Bash
- **Security & High Availability:** Encryption, Disaster Recovery, HA Clustering, Backup Solutions

LEADERSHIP & RECOGNITION

- 15+ years in managerial roles leading database and systems/project teams of up to 12 professionals.
- Recognized for building resilient IT environments and mentoring future database engineers.
- Awarded Half Colours in Academics — Peterhouse College.
- Successfully reduced departmental operational costs by 30% through strategic automation and cloud optimization.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.